

Complete Theme

Vocabulary — 25 words

Word	IPA	Turkish	Example
acquaintance <i>noun</i>	/ə'kweɪntəns/	tanıdık	He's just an acquaintance, not a close friend, whom I met at a school event.
loyal <i>adj</i>	/ˈlɔɪəl/	sadık	A loyal friend is someone who stays by your side even in difficult times.
reliable <i>adj</i>	/rɪˈlaɪəbl/	güvenilir	Ayşe is the kind of friend who is always reliable when you need help.
trustworthy <i>adj</i>	/ˈtrʌstwɜːrði/	güvenilir	I only share secrets with friends whom I find trustworthy.
bond <i>noun</i>	/bɒnd/	bağ	The bond between the two friends grew stronger after the trip they took together.
companion <i>noun</i>	/kəmˈpæniən/	arkadaş, yoldaş	She was my companion on every school trip I ever went on.
outgoing <i>adj</i>	/ˈaʊtɡoʊɪŋ/	girişken, dışa dönük	My friend, who is very outgoing, makes new friends wherever she goes.
sincere <i>adj</i>	/sɪnˈsɪr/	samimi	His sincere apology, which he gave in front of everyone, repaired their friendship.
get along (with) <i>phrasal verb</i>	/ɡet əˈlɔːŋ/	iyi geçinmek	The classmates who get along best usually sit together at lunch.
have (something) in common <i>expression</i>	/hæv ɪn ˈkɒmən/	ortak yönü olmak	The friends, who have a lot in common, enjoy the same hobbies and music.
gathering <i>noun</i>	/ˈɡæðərɪŋ/	toplantı, buluşma	The gathering, which took place at Deniz's house, lasted until midnight.
reunion <i>noun</i>	/riːˈjuːnjən/	yeniden buluşma	We are planning a reunion for the classmates who graduated five years ago.
confide (in) <i>verb</i>	/kənˈfaɪd/	sır vermek, güvenmek	She is the friend whom I confide in whenever something is bothering me.
support (someone) <i>verb</i>	/səˈpɔːrt/	desteklemek	The teammates who supported me during the competition became close friends.
misunderstanding <i>noun</i>	/ˌmɪsʌndərˈstændɪŋ/	yanlış anlama	The misunderstanding, which started over a text message, was quickly cleared up.

Word	IPA	Turkish	Example
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clarify <i>verb</i>	/ˈklærɪfaɪ/	açıklığa kavuşturmak	Could you clarify what you meant when you said the plan had changed?
explain further <i>expression</i>	/ɪkˈspleɪn ˈfɜːrðər/	daha fazla açıklamak	I asked my friend to explain further because I hadn't understood the reason.
rephrase <i>verb</i>	/riːˈfreɪz/	yeniden ifade etmek	She rephrased her question so that her friend could understand it more easily.
in other words <i>expression</i>	/ɪn ˈʌðər wɜːrds/	başka bir deyişle	In other words, what I meant was that we should meet earlier than planned.
get confused <i>expression</i>	/ɡet kənˈfjuːzd/	kafası karışmak	I got confused about the meeting place, so I asked my friend to clarify.
make sense <i>expression</i>	/meɪk sɛns/	mantıklı olmak, anlaşılır olmak	Your explanation didn't make sense to me at first, so I asked another question.
generous <i>adj</i>	/ˈdʒɛnərəs/	cömert	He is a generous friend who always shares his notes before exams.
supportive <i>adj</i>	/səˈpɔːrtɪv/	destekleyici	My classmates were very supportive when I was struggling with the project.
childhood friend <i>noun phrase</i>	/ˈtʃaɪldhʊd frɛnd/	çocukluk arkadaşı	Elif is a childhood friend whom I have known since primary school.
drift apart <i>phrasal verb</i>	/drɪft əˈpɑːrt/	birbirinden uzaklaşmak	The two friends drifted apart after one of them moved to another city.

Relative Clauses — who/which/that/whose (defining) and where/when/why

We use defining relative clauses to give essential information that identifies exactly which person, thing, place, time or reason we are talking about, without which the sentence would not make full sense. We use who/that for people, which/that for things, whose to show possession, where for places, when for times, and why for reasons. Defining relative clauses are not separated by commas.

Belirten (defining) sıfat cümleciklerini, hakkında konuşulan kişi, şey, yer, zaman ya da sebebi tam olarak belirlemek için gereken, cümlelerin anlamı için gerekli bilgiyi vermek amacıyla kullanırız; bu bilgi olmadan cümle eksik kalır. İnsanlar için who/that, nesneler için which/that, sahiplik için whose, yerler için where, zamanlar için when, sebepler için why kullanılır. Belirten sıfat cümlecikleri virgülle ayrılmaz.

When? Use a defining relative clause whenever the listener needs the extra information to know exactly who or what you mean; if you removed the clause, the sentence would become unclear or too general.

Dinleyicinin tam olarak kimi ya da neyi kastettiğini anlaması için ek bilgiye ihtiyacı olduğunda belirten sıfat cümlecigi kullanılır; bu cümlecik çıkarılırsa cümle belirsiz ya da çok genel hale gelir.

Positive

- The person who/that helps me is my friend.
- The place where we meet is a café.
- The reason why she left is unclear.

Negative

- The person who doesn't help me isn't a real friend.
- The place where we don't usually go is quiet.

Question

- Is he the friend who called you yesterday?
- Is this the café where you met your friend?

Short answers

- Yes, he's the one who called.
- Yes, that's the place where we met.

Common mistakes

- ~~This is the girl which is my best friend.~~ → **This is the girl who is my best friend.**
- ~~That's the café, where we always meet.~~ → **That's the café where we always meet.**
- ~~He is the boy who's bag is red.~~ → **He is the boy whose bag is red.**
- ~~I remember the day which we met.~~ → **I remember the day when we met.**

1. The teacher _____ taught us last year has moved to another school.

2. Balıkesir is the city _____ I was born.

3. Choose the correct sentence.

- a. This is the friend which helped me.
- b. This is the friend who helped me.
- c. This is the friend where helped me.
- d. This is the friend whose helped me.

4. That's the boy, who's brother plays football with me. — *True / False*

5. Put the words in order: the / I / trust / most / is / person / who / Elif

6. Combine: I have a friend. My friend's sister is a doctor. (*I have a friend...*)

7. The reason _____ we became friends was our shared love of music.

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- a. where
 - b. when
 - c. why
 - d. whose

8. That's the gathering _____ all my classmates met last summer.

9. Combine: I remember a day. We laughed together all day. (*I remember the day...*)

10. Which sentence correctly uses a defining relative clause without a comma?

- a. The café, where we meet is nice.
- b. The café where we meet is nice.
- c. The café, where we meet, is nice.
- d. The café who we meet is nice.

11. Do you know the reason _____ she moved to another city?

Defining vs. Non-defining Relative Clauses

A defining relative clause gives essential information without which the sentence loses its meaning, and it is not separated by commas. A non-defining relative clause adds extra, non-essential information about someone or something already identified (often a name or a unique place), and it is separated by commas. 'That' can replace who/which in defining clauses but not in non-defining clauses.

Belirten (defining) sıfat cümlecği, çıkarıldığında cümlenin anlamını kaybettiği temel bilgiyi verir ve virgülle ayrılmaz. Belirtmeyen (non-defining) sıfat cümlecği ise zaten tanımlanmış bir kişi ya da şey (genellikle bir isim ya da tek bir yer) hakkında ek, gereksiz olmayan ama zorunlu da olmayan bilgi verir ve virgülle ayrılır. 'That', belirten cümleciklerde who/which yerine kullanılabilir ama belirtmeyen cümleciklerde kullanılamaz.

When? Choose non-defining when the person or place is already clearly identified (a name, 'my mother', a capital city) and you are only adding extra detail; choose defining when the clause is needed to say exactly who or what you mean.

Kişi ya da yer zaten açıkça belirlenmişse (bir isim, 'annem', bir başkent gibi) ve sadece ek bir bilgi ekleniyorsa belirtmeyen cümlecik; tam olarak kimi ya da neyi kastettiğinizi belirtmek gerekiyorsa belirten cümlecik seçilir.

Positive

- The boy who called me is my cousin. (defining)
- Emre, who called me, is my cousin. (non-defining)

Negative

- The boy who didn't call me is my cousin.
- Emre, who didn't call me, is my cousin.

Question

- Is the boy who called you your cousin?
- Is Emre, who called you, your cousin?

Short answers

- Yes, he is.
- Yes, he is.

Common mistakes

- ~~My mother who lives in Balıkesir called me.~~ → **My mother, who lives in Balıkesir, called me.**
- ~~The friend, that helped me, is very kind.~~ → **The friend that helped me is very kind.**
- ~~My best friend Deniz who I trust most.~~ → **My best friend Deniz, whom I trust most, always helps me.**

1. My father, who works at the hospital, is very supportive. — *True / False*

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2. Choose the correctly punctuated sentence.

- a. My sister who lives in İzmir, is a doctor.
- b. My sister, who lives in İzmir, is a doctor.
- c. My sister, who lives in İzmir is a doctor.
- d. My sister who lives in İzmir is a doctor, is a doctor.

3. The book _____ I'm reading now is about a group of childhood friends. (defining, can use 'that')

4. Combine, making it non-defining: My teacher helped me a lot. My teacher's name is Ms. Kaya. (*Ms. Kaya, my teacher,...*)

5. Put in order: is / my / cousin / Deniz / who / lives / in / Bursa

6. 'That' can be used instead of 'who/which' in _____.

- a. non-defining clauses only
- b. defining clauses only
- c. both types equally
- d. neither type

7. Combine as a non-defining clause: Ankara is the capital of Turkey. Ankara has many good universities. (*Ankara, which...*)

8. The girl that is my cousin, lives in İstanbul. — *True / False*

9. My best friend, _____ I have known since childhood, always makes me laugh.

The Friend Who Never Gave Up on Me

Before you read

- Look at the title. What kind of friend do you think the writer is describing?
- Think of a friend who has supported you during a difficult time.

Everyone has a friend who they will never forget, and for me, that friend is Ceren. We met in the seventh grade, on the first day when our new class was formed, and we have been close ever since. Ceren is the kind of person who notices when something is wrong, even before you say a word.

Two years ago, I was going through a difficult period at school, which affected my grades and my confidence. Ceren, who could see that I was struggling, started walking home with me every day just to talk. She never told me what to do; instead, she asked questions that helped me understand my own feelings better.

The place where we had our longest conversations was a small park near our school, which has a bench under an old tree. That bench is where we solved most of our problems, from small arguments with classmates to bigger worries about the future. It became a kind of second home for us.

What I admire most about Ceren is her loyalty. She is a friend whose honesty I can always trust, even when the truth is uncomfortable. Last year, when I made a decision that most people disagreed with, Ceren was the only one who asked me to explain my reasons before judging me.

Now that we are in different classes, we don't see each other every day, but the bond we built has not weakened. Whenever I need someone to talk to, Ceren is still the first person I call. She taught me that a real friend is someone who stays, not just when things are easy, but especially when they are not.

1. When did the writer and Ceren first meet?

- a. In primary school
- b. On the first day of seventh grade
- c. At a birthday party
- d. During a school trip

2. Ceren told the writer exactly what to do to solve the problem. — *True / False*

3. The bench under the old tree is the place _____ they had their longest conversations.

4. What does the writer admire most about Ceren?

- a. Her sense of humour
- b. Her loyalty and honesty
- c. Her intelligence
- d. Her generosity with money

5. Rewrite as one sentence using a relative pronoun: The writer made a decision. Most people disagreed with the decision. (*The writer made a decision...*)

6. According to the text, Ceren and the writer are now in the same class. — *True / False*

After you read

- Do you agree that a real friend is someone who stays during difficult times? Why or why not?
- Describe a place that is special to you and a friend, using *where*.

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Our Ten-Year Reunion

Before you read

- What do you think happens at a class reunion?
- Have you ever met a childhood friend again after a long time?

Last month, my old classmates and I organised a reunion, which took place exactly ten years after we finished middle school. The event, which was held in a restaurant near our old school, brought together almost thirty former students, some of whom I hadn't seen since graduation.

The person who worked hardest to organise everything was Burak, a classmate whose energy for planning events never seems to disappear. He created a group chat where everyone could share memories, photos and, eventually, their availability for the big day.

When the evening finally arrived, it was strange to see faces that I remembered as children now belonging to adults with jobs, families and completely different lives. The first person I recognised was Selin, whose laugh had not changed at all in ten years. We talked for almost an hour about the summer when our whole class went camping together.

One moment that made everyone emotional was when we watched an old video, which someone had saved from our final week of school. In the video, our teacher, who had since retired, gave a short speech about friendship that none of us had fully understood at the age of fourteen.

By the end of the night, we had exchanged numbers, made plans for a smaller gathering, and remembered why some of these friendships, despite the years when we drifted apart, still mattered. As Burak said in his closing toast, a good friend is someone who, no matter how much time passes, can still make you feel like you're fifteen again.

1. How long after graduation did the reunion take place?
 - a. Five years
 - b. Eight years
 - c. Ten years
 - d. Fifteen years
2. Burak created a group chat _____ everyone could share memories and photos.
3. Selin's laugh had changed a lot in ten years. — *True / False*
4. What made everyone emotional during the reunion?
 - a. A speech by Burak
 - b. An old video from their final week of school
 - c. A photo slideshow
 - d. A gift from the teacher
5. Combine: Our teacher gave a speech about friendship. Our teacher had since retired. (*Our teacher, who...*)

6. According to Burak's toast, what makes someone a good friend?

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- a. Living nearby
 - b. Being able to make you feel young again despite time passing
 - c. Remembering everyone's name
 - d. Organising events well

After you read

- Would you enjoy attending a reunion with old classmates ten years from now? Why or why not?
- Describe a childhood friend whose personality you remember clearly.

Who Is That in the Photo?

Before you listen

- Look at the title. What do you think the speakers are talking about?
- Predict two questions one speaker might ask the other for clarification.

1. Why does Speaker A ask Speaker B to clarify who Naz is?

- a. A doesn't believe B
- b. A isn't sure if Naz is a neighbour or a family friend
- c. A thinks Naz looks familiar
- d. A wants to meet Naz

2. Emir is Speaker B's cousin. — *True / False*

3. The photo was taken at the garden _____ the reception was held.

4. Which expression does Speaker B use to give more explanation?

- a. "I'm confused"
- b. "Let me explain further"
- c. "Could you clarify?"
- d. "That makes sense"

5. What is Emir's role connected to the wedding?

- a. He is the groom
- b. He organised most of the wedding games
- c. He took the photos
- d. He is Naz's brother

Describe Your Friend

Pairs · 8-10 min

Describe a close friend to your partner using at least three relative clauses (who/which/that/whose/where/when/why), while your partner listens and asks for clarification when needed.

Useful language: This is a friend who..., We met at a place where..., Could you clarify what you mean by...?, In other words,..., Sorry, could you explain that a bit more?

1. Think of one close friend and note down three facts about them (personality, a shared place, a shared memory).
2. Take turns describing your friend to your partner using relative clauses.
3. The listener must ask at least one clarification question during the description.
4. The speaker answers by rephrasing or explaining further.
5. Switch roles and repeat.

A Memorable Event with Friends

Groups of 3-4 · 10 min

Take turns telling your group about a memorable event you shared with friends, explaining where it happened, when it happened, and why it was memorable, while the group asks clarifying questions.

Useful language: It happened at a place where..., It was the year when..., The reason why it was special was..., Sorry, what do you mean by...?, So, in other words, you're saying...

1. Think individually of one memorable event with friends for one minute.
2. In your group, take turns telling your story, using relative clauses to add detail.
3. After each story, at least two group members must ask a clarification question.
4. The speaker responds by giving clarification, rephrasing where necessary.
5. As a group, decide whose story was the most memorable and why.

Writing

A Portrait of My Best Friend

120-150 words

Write a descriptive paragraph about your best friend, using at least four relative clauses to describe their personality, a place you share, and a memorable event together.

Plan:

1. Note down your friend's name and three personality traits.
2. Think of a place that is special to your friendship and why.
3. Think of one memorable event you experienced together.
4. Organise your ideas: introduction, personality, shared place/event, conclusion.

Checklist:

- ☐ I used at least four relative clauses correctly.
- ☐ I used commas correctly for non-defining clauses.
- ☐ I included personality, a place, and an event.
- ☐ My paragraph has a clear introduction and conclusion.
- ☐ I checked my spelling and punctuation.

Clarifying a Misunderstanding

80-100 words

Write a short message to a friend clarifying something you said earlier that caused a misunderstanding, explaining what you really meant.

Plan:

1. Note down what the misunderstanding was about.
2. Decide what you actually meant to say.
3. Choose polite clarifying expressions to use.
4. Write a friendly, clear message.

Checklist:

- ☐ I clearly explained the misunderstanding.
- ☐ I used at least two clarification expressions.
- ☐ My tone is friendly and polite.
- ☐ My message is within the word limit.
- ☐ I checked my grammar and spelling.

1. Choose the correct relative pronoun: This is the friend _____ helped me move house.
 - a. which
 - b. who
 - c. where
 - d. whose
2. That's the park _____ we used to play as children.
3. My mother who works at a hospital called me this morning. — *True / False*
4. Which word means 'someone you can trust completely'?
 - a. acquaintance
 - b. trustworthy
 - c. outgoing
 - d. confused
5. Combine: I have a neighbour. My neighbour's daughter is my classmate. (*I have a neighbour...*)
6. Which phrase is used to ask for clarification?
 - a. In other words...
 - b. Could you clarify that?
 - c. I got confused.
 - d. That makes sense.
7. Put the words in order: is / friend / a / me / who / always / supports / she
8. I still remember the summer _____ we became best friends.
9. In the reading 'The Friend Who Never Gave Up on Me', where did the writer and Ceren usually talk?
 - a. At school
 - b. On a bench in a park
 - c. At Ceren's house
 - d. On the phone
10. In the listening, Emir organised the wedding ceremony itself. — *True / False*

Support

1. Write four simple sentences describing your friends using 'who', following the given examples.
2. Match five vocabulary words from this theme to their Turkish meanings.
3. Complete four gap-fill sentences choosing between who/which/where from a word bank.
4. Copy and complete three short clarification phrases from the listening dialogue.

Core

1. Write a short paragraph (80-100 words) describing a friend using at least three relative clauses.
2. Complete six mixed practice questions on defining relative clauses.
3. Write two short messages: one asking for clarification and one giving it.
4. List five theme vocabulary words and use each one in an original sentence.

Extension

1. Write a 150-word description comparing two friends using both defining and non-defining relative clauses.
2. Record yourself describing a memorable event with friends, including at least four relative clauses.
3. Rewrite five simple sentence pairs from your own life as single sentences using relative clauses.
4. Write a short dialogue (6-8 lines) between two friends where one asks for clarification and the other explains further.

Vocabulary

1. Which word describes a friend who always keeps their promises?
 - a. outgoing
 - b. reliable
 - c. acquaintance
 - d. sincere
2. The two friends _____ apart after one of them moved abroad.
3. What does 'confide in someone' mean?
 - a. To argue with someone
 - b. To share secrets or feelings with someone you trust
 - c. To ignore someone
 - d. To meet someone by chance

Grammar

1. The girl _____ sits next to me in class is my new friend.
2. My best friend Elif who I met in primary school lives in İzmir now. — *True / False*
3. Which sentence is correct?
 - a. The reason which she left is unclear.
 - b. The reason why she left is unclear.
 - c. The reason where she left is unclear.
 - d. The reason who she left is unclear.
4. Combine: This is the house. We had our first party there. (*This is the house...*)

Reading

1. In 'Our Ten-Year Reunion', who organised the event?
 - a. Selin
 - b. The teacher
 - c. Burak
 - d. The narrator
2. In 'The Friend Who Never Gave Up on Me', Ceren told the narrator exactly what to do. — *True / False*

Listening

1. In the dialogue, what does Speaker A ask Speaker B to do when confused?

- a. Repeat the question
- b. Clarify or explain further
- c. Change the subject
- d. Show a different photo

2. Naz is a friend _____ family lives near Speaker B's in the summer.

Writing

1. Write one sentence describing a friend's personality using a relative clause.